Prayer

Purpose: *Prayer is powerful, effectual, and necessary for the disciple of Christ. There are certain conditions that will ensure that our prayers are heard.*

Centred on: *Prayer is how we communicate with our saviour.*

The first 4 verses kind of make the same point. So just fly through them.

Background for Mark: Mark uses the word immediately at least 40 times. This is by far the instance when it is most commonly used.. The next highest occurrence of the word is in another gospel where it is used in dispairing contrast only 8 times. Mark was a man of action. And he presents Jesus as an action man too. When the whole city came to Jesus to be healed He says it matter of factly in one verse (1:32) and then moves to the next thing.

Mark 1:35…However in this verse takes the time to describe the detail. How Jesus took time out to spend with His Father in solitude. Interesting too, scholars agree that this early morning time frame was between 3-6 AM definitely before the dawn.

Luke 6:12…Jesus spends time right before He picks the 12 disciples. (This tells me that He was asking for wisdom to make a good choice)

Luke 9:28…Even though He was God, He prayed often by himself. He validated individual and corporate prayer. And He found it necessary to spend time in prayer. How much more should we as His disciples see our need of prayer and spend time communicating with our Heavenly Father?

Matthew 5:3,6…Do you ever feel like you aren't good enough to come to God? This text turns things around and contrasts the way the world views things and the way that heaven and God views things. We can be encouraged because when we see our need, or how bad we are, our sinfulness, it opens the way for God to bless us and to restore us.

Matthew 7:7,8… ask, seek, knock. In the Greek, the verb tense is a continuous, uninterrupted action. Keep asking, Keep seeking, Keep knocking.

Romans 8:32… (This text could be cut out) It is a promise that the God we are asking from and who invites us to ask Him, does not want to withhold things from us. He even gave us His Son.

Psalm 66:18 …If we are knowingly holding onto something and not willing to change, we are rendering our prayers useless.
+ This is a text for proud people, if its someone who realizes their need, and is doubtful you might want to skip it because it would just lead to more doubt.

Psalm 28:13… transitions itself in well. Second half of verse is a beautiful promise. When we come with humility and sincerity we are met with love and compassion. It's a two step process: confessing and forsaking. When we come humbly He hears our Prayers

Hebrews 11:6 …In this text we are given a Principle of Prayer. You'll notice the recurrence of the word seek. We must have faith, that God can answer our prayers. When we come to God we should expect things because He has promised. If we feel like our faith is lacking, we can ask him to help our unbelief. Approach God with the attitude of taking Him at His word. (Could incorporate James 1:6 possibly)

Mark 11:24… people will nod their heads in agreement but in the back of their heads they will be like… uh no. Believe that you have already received it, and it will be given to you. Act like you have already have the answer to your prayer. Ill. Smoker, if you are praying for victory over smoking. When you finish praying you need to act like you are an ex smoker, like you already have received victory for it.

James 4:1-3… so what can we ask for then? What was Jesus actually communicating in Mark 11:24? Verse 1 and 2 set the stage for verse 3. Verse 3 is the qualifier. You don't receive because your motive is wrong. Wrong motive and pleasure would be key words. Here is where you should insert a story. Many times the things we think we need most we can look back and say Praise God that He didn't give them to us.

So ask with assurance, but ask on the word of God not on our own whims.

1 John 5:14 …according to His will (key words) So what are the things that are according to God's will?

Luke 11:1-13… model prayer on the things to pray for, we can pray with assurance. You can explain the progression of the prayer. Example: God wants to take care of our needs (daily bread) he wants to forgive us, but we must forgive others. V. 11 asking for the Holy Spirit is always in line with God's will for us. Underline 'Holy Spirit'

James 5:13-18…Talks specifically about health problems but can be left out

Colossians 4:2-4 … in verse 2 Paul tells us to devout ourselves to prayer or continue in prayer. Underline 'thanksgiving'; make sure to thank God for what He has given us. Verse 3, 4 Enlist their prayers on behalf of the Gospel work, would you pray for me as I'm trying to lead people to Jesus.

Psalm 55:17… Psalmist set aside certain times of the day for prayer

1 Thess 5:17 …pray without ceasing,

Psalm 55:17, 1 Thess 5:17 …go right along with Colossians that we need to devout ourselves to prayer

Appeal:

Phillipians 4:6 … (Appeal) Be anxious for nothing, don't be overcome with fears, we can present ourselves before God and He promises His peace will guard our hearts and minds

Do you ever face challenges in life, things come up that you just aren't sure what to do? Isn't it encouraging that God wants us to come to Him with the faith of a child believing that He will take care of us and that he promises to give us peace. Do you want to say today God I want to give my cares to you I want to entrust my life to you?

How to formulate Appeals: When I read a text how does it make me feel, what does my heart feel and then verbalize it

Defend it:

Posture in Prayer: Isaiah 38:1, 2; 2 Samuel 12:16-20 laid on ground; Nehemiah 2:4 in-thought prayer; 2 Chronicles 6:12 standing, lifting hands; Mark 11:25 standing; Daniel 6:10 kneeling; Matthew 15:35 sit down and then prayed.

Matthew 6:7…Don't use vain repetitions i.e. Hail Mary's (Catholics, Episcopalians) Col. 4:2 Keep alert in it

Faith in Prayer: Romans 12:3 God has given to each a measure of faith
Romans 10:17 Faith comes by hearing and hearing by the word of God
Mark 9:22-24 I believe; Help thou my unbelief

Asking for a good thing: Daniel 10:2-3, 10-13 there are other factors; we don't know all 7the details but be persistent.

E.G. White. Prayer is the answer to every problem in life. RH 10/7/1895